

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of the Perfection of Wisdom

Āryaprajñāpāramitānāmāṣṭaśatakaṃ · Toh 553 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་རལ་དུ་ཞུ་བའི་མཆན་བར་རྒྱ་བར་དུ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ

Toh 553 in the Kangyur is a devotional text known in Sanskrit as the Āryaprajñāpāramitānāmāṣṭaśataka and in Tibetan as the Phags pa shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa'i mtshan brgya rtsa brgyad pa, rendered in English as the Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of the Perfection of Wisdom. It belongs to the Perfection of Wisdom class of texts within the Kangyur and takes the form of a hymn or praise text enumerating one hundred and eight epithets of the Perfection of Wisdom personified as a blessed female deity, regarded as the mother of all buddhas of past, present, and future. The text opens with a verse prologue proclaiming its intention to recite these names for the benefit of those who wish to prosper, before proceeding through the enumerated epithets in sequence. As a praise text centered on the Perfection of Wisdom, it sits at the intersection of the prajñāpāramitā literary tradition and devotional practice directed toward wisdom as a sacred feminine principle.

I prostrate. The Praise by the Eight Girls is complete.

In the language of India: Āryaprajñāpāramitānāmāṣṭaśatakaṃ. In the Tibetan language: The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of the Perfection of Wisdom.

Homage to the Blessed Lady, the Perfection of Wisdom.

Those Victors of the past, the future, and the present —
you, virtuous one, are the mother of them all.

You are a goddess, a daughter of the Victors.

You possess an intrinsic nature that is the very absence of intrinsic nature.

The names of that mother of all buddhas,
the virtuous one, I shall now proclaim.

Let those who wish to prosper listen well.

The Perfection of Wisdom. Omniscience. Knowledge of the paths. Knowledge of all aspects. The perfect limit. Suchness. Non-erring suchness. Non-other suchness. Truth. Reality. The real. The non-inverted. Emptiness. Signlessness. Wishlessness. Non-thingness. Essential nature. The essential nature of non-thingness. The nature of reality (dharmatā). The basic space of

phenomena (dharmadhātu). The permanence of phenomena. The immutability of phenomena. The faultlessness of phenomena. The defining characteristic of phenomena. The selflessness of phenomena. The absence of essential nature. The absence of sentient beings. The absence of a life principle. The absence of a nourisher. The absence of a person. The absence of an individual. The expressible. The inexpressible. Free from mind, mentation, and consciousness. Without equal. Without a peer. Without self-possession in equality. Without arrogance. Without conceptual elaboration. Separated from conceptual elaboration. Separated from all conceptual elaboration. Gone entirely beyond all conceptual elaboration. The mother of all buddhas. The one who gives birth to all bodhisattvas. The one who holds all śrāvakas. The one who generates all pratyekabuddhas. The one who sustains all the world. The one who has amassed an inexhaustible accumulation of merit. She from whom wisdom flows. The one who performs miraculous feats. The one who fully purifies the divine eye. The one who fully purifies the divine ear. The one who bestows knowledge of others' minds. The one who bestows recollection of former lives. The one who bestows knowledge of death and birth. The one who exhausts all afflictions. The noble one. The pure one. The cleansed one. The one who abides in the close placements of mindfulness. The one endowed with the power of the four perfect abandonments. The one endowed with the feet of the four bases of miraculous power. The one who purifies the faculties. The one who creates strength. The one who is without fault. The one made beautiful by the seven precious limbs of awakening. The one who bestows the seven noble riches. The one who teaches the noble eightfold path. The one who teaches the nine sequential meditative absorptions. The one who accomplishes the ten masteries. The one who causes abiding on the ten grounds. The one who brings the ten powers to perfect completion. The one made beautiful by the ten sense sources leading to exhaustion. The one who accomplishes the ten knowledges. The one who destroys the enemy of the ten underlying tendencies. The one who accomplishes the meditative concentrations. The one who causes complete transcendence of the formless realm. The one praised by all perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. The one who accomplishes all knowledges. The one who brings all the perfections to completion. Inner emptiness. Outer emptiness. Inner and outer emptiness. The emptiness of emptiness. Great emptiness. Ultimate emptiness. The emptiness of conditioned phenomena. The emptiness of unconditioned phenomena. The emptiness that transcends all extremes. The emptiness of

having no beginning and no end. The emptiness of non-abandonment. The emptiness of intrinsic nature. The emptiness of all phenomena. The emptiness of individual defining characteristics. The emptiness of the non-apprehensible. The emptiness of non-existence. The emptiness of essential nature. The emptiness of the essential nature of non-existence.

Not arisen. Not born. Not ceased. Without annihilation. Without permanence. Not of single meaning. Not of different meaning. Without coming. Without going. Cultivating the meditation on dependent origination. Not to be thoroughly analyzed. Not to be distinguished by consciousness. Without ground. Without defining characteristics. Not to be examined. Not to be known. Making beginning and end free from destruction. Making free from movement. Without duality. Not without duality. Peaceful. Freed from the engagement of discursive thought. Without antidote. Undefined. Like the path of space. Not to be expressed as existence or non-existence. Having the essential nature of a dream. The nature of reality like an illusion. Like a firebrand whirled in a circle — all phenomena are of one taste.

Whoever recites these one hundred and eight names of the Perfection of Wisdom will be utterly liberated from all lower rebirths. All buddhas too will hold that person in their thoughts. All bodhisattvas will constantly and continuously guard, protect, and shelter that person. These words of the secret mantra should also be kept in mind always, without interruption.

Homage to the Blessed Lady, the noble Perfection of Wisdom — loving friend to the devoted, endowed with immeasurable qualities, the very omniscient wisdom of all Tathāgatas, the object of reverence of all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

It is as follows: Oṃ prajñe prajñe mahāprajñe, prajñā avabhāse, prajñā ālokaḥ, ajñānavidyamāne, siddhi, susiddhi, sidhyamāne, bhagavati sarvāṃgasundarī, bhagavati, bṛhasali, prasāritahaste, samāśvāsakari, tiṣṭha tiṣṭha, kampa kampa, cala cala, rāva rāva, garja garja, āgaccha āgaccha, bhagavati māvilambasva hā.

Whoever upholds this Perfection of Wisdom will thereby uphold the Perfection of Wisdom in one hundred thousand verses. If it is recited constantly, all karmic obscurations of that person will be purified. Even after passing from this life and being reborn, one will retain the memory of past lives, one's mind will be at ease, and one will possess incomparable wisdom. One will uphold, without remainder, all the Dharma of every Tathāgata of the three times. All

The noble Perfection of Wisdom with One Hundred and Eight Names

- The passage is the opening section of the Āryaprajñāpāramitānāmāṣṭaśataka, the One Hundred and Eight Names of the Perfection of Wisdom. It begins with a closing colophon for a preceding text (the Praise by the Eight Girls), then transitions into the title and opening homage verse of the Names text, followed by a long prose enumeration of names or epithets.

"The ten sense sources leading to exhaustion" translates 十塵緣起盡相, a somewhat unusual compound; the reference is likely to the ten sense bases in their aspect of being exhausted or transcended at high stages of realization, though this specific phrasing is not standard and some uncertainty attaches to the precise doctrinal referent.

The phrase rendered "not without duality" for 二無雙 preserves a deliberate paradox found in Prajñāpāramitā literature: the text affirms neither duality nor the simple negation of duality, pointing beyond both poles.

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May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.